

Switches or Belkin's WeMo Light Switches, as we earlier mentioned, are convenient because of their closeness to the switches we currently use. So if you want to keep your normal wall-controls while being able to automate them, you've got your answer.

On the other hand, smart plugs, like Belkin's WeMo Switch Smart Plug, and the iDevices switch, offer the same features, with additional features such as energy consumption reports. You'll only have to plug in the smart plug into an existing plug, while continuing to use the same switch used to flip it on and off. If you can shell out a few more thousand, smart plugs form a better alternative to smart switches, though the ability to use them for inbuilt light fixtures gets reduced.

In case you're on a strict budget, a combination of remotely controlled light switches and LED/CFL bulbs, with a smart plug thrown in, should suffice.

One of the most popular light switches available in the market is the Belkin WeMo Light Switch, which can be ordered from overseas or in India for around ₹4100.

While it's one of the more expensive options available, it's also quite versatile, considering it uses WiFi for remote communication. So as long as you're connected to the internet, you can monitor your lighting remotely. The light switch will have to be installed manually, by taking off your current switch plate and hooking up the WeMo light switch directly to the wiring. The switch is integrated with IFTT, and you can also use the WeMo app to create custom settings that provide timer functions. A point worth noting is the ability to integrate this WeMo device with the SmartThings hub, in case you plan to extend your home automation system (keep in mind that SmartThings doesn't officially support WeMo devices, though there are many DIY ways to integrate it). It's also controllable through Amazon Alexa, even though that is a redundant point for Indian customers due to the non-availability of Alexa in India.

The TP- Link Smart Wi-Fi Light Switch, which would cost you around ₹3700, is quite similar to the Belkin WeMo Light Switch. It works with Amazon Alexa, but not SmartThings. On the other hand, GE Lighting



Belkin WeMo Light Switch